

Orc

The Orcs of Pliara differ wildly from one another in both appearance and behavior. While many orcs live up to the stereotype of aggression, anger, and chaos, many others live very different lives. Some Orcs are shepherds of the wild, traveling around in a nomadic pursuit.

Other Orcs build colonies in the trees and live among the wilds of the jungle. Regardless of behavior or appearance, all orcs in Pliara share a similar ancestry and, as such, have very defining characteristics.

Their faces are long with large, under-developed noses. In some cases, Orcs lack nostrils completely, giving them a snout-like appearance. Averaging between 6'6" and 7'6" with powerful builds and gray, brown, or green-tinted skin, Orcs are monstrous creatures. Their canine teeth often protrude from their mouths as tusks, pointing upwards towards their large, oversized eyebrows. While most Orcs won't be found studying a book, they often excel in tasks requiring brute strength.

Although Jungle Orcs and Plains Orcs frequently do not meet the stereotypes set before them by the savage Pliaran Orcs, most other races fear all Orcs. The brutal savagery of Pliaran Orcs has spun tales, fact and fiction, throughout all of Pliara. Many Elven children are told bedtime stories of being taken by Orcs and turned into slaves if they misbehaved, forced to work alongside the Humans. These stereotypes and prejudices make it difficult for even the nicest of Plains or Jungle Orc to become trusted in a new place, even as a merchant or tradesman.

Racial Traits

Ability Scores. Your Strength Score increases by 2.

Age. Orcs mature a little faster than humans, reaching adulthood around age 12. They live to be about 85 years old.

Alignment. Orcish cultures tend toward a live-and-let-live worldview. People raised among orcs are not as often lawful, tending instead toward a more relaxed attitude. Orcish disposition versus good and evil varies wildly based on the sub-race of Orc.

Size. Orcs are somewhat larger and bulkier than humans, and they range from 5 to 8 feet tall, depending on sub-race. Your average Pliaran Orc will stand between 7 and 8 feet tall, for example, while a Jungle Orc may only grow to be 5 feet tall. Either way, your size is Medium.

Speed. Your base walking speed is 30 feet.

Darkvision. You can see in dim light within 60 feet of you as if it were bright light, and in darkness as if it were dim light. You cannot discern color in darkness, only shades of gray.

Languages. You can speak, read, and write Common and Orcish.

Relentless Endurance. When you are reduced to 0 hit points but not killed outright, you can drop to 1 hit point instead. You can't use this feature again until you finish a long rest.

Intimidating Appearance. You have proficiency in the Intimidation skill.

Orc Sub-Races

Jungle Orc

Jungle Orcs are a unique breed of orc native to the thick, ancient canopies of places like Amobo, Corrow, and the Wild Hook. Standing noticeably shorter than their massive Pliaran kin, these tree-dwelling nomads average around five feet tall and feature elongated arms designed for moving effortlessly through the branches. Their hunched posture and heavy, calloused knuckles allow them to move swiftly along both the forest floor and the highest limbs, making them exceptional climbers and trackers.

Despite their intimidating physical presence, complete with long faces, snout-like features, and upward-curving tusks, Jungle Orcs reject the brutal reputation usually attached to their kind. They build elaborate arboreal civilizations high above the ground and act as dedicated caretakers of the wilderness. Driven by a desire for harmony rather than conflict, their communities value quiet, steady coexistence with the natural world over conquest or bloodshed.

Their culture revolves around protection, craftsmanship, and a deep understanding of the environment. Utilizing light weapons like scimitars alongside traditional clubs, Jungle Orcs navigate the dense foliage with unmatched agility and grace. Whether tending to the canopy or trading goods across their forest territories, they remain one of the most peaceful and adaptable societies in the realm.

Ability Scores. Your Dexterity Score increases by 1.

Jungle Orc Weaponry. You have proficiency with the club, greatclub, and scimitar.

High Climber. You have a climbing speed equal to your walking speed.

Plains Orc

The Plains Orc are a nomadic people, always seeking to explore new lands and travel the world. While sometimes they prefer to travel alone, it is most common to see a group of 2 to 4 Plains Orcs travelling together alongside a flock of sheep, goats, or other pack animal.

Those Plains Orcs who do establish a more permanent home will often do so only with the intent to build a farm, ranch, or preserve. Many of the produce in Pliara comes from Plains Orc ranches and farms. They are known herd livestock of all types and primarily eat meat. Utilizing every part of the animals they kill, these Orcs are often seen dressed in tanned hides or leathers. To the Plains Orcs, every kill is to be worshipped as a gift, and taking a life from the world must be done responsibly.

Plains Orcs are, for the most part, the calmest and most spiritually enlightened of the Orc sub-races. Most Plains Orcs worship Plii herself, while others worship Arnyss Torunn. Many Plains Orcs lean towards a Neutral Alignment while leaning towards a more Druidic or Monk lifestyle; however, many Plains Orcs are known to learn a wide array of skills as artisans as well.

Ability Scores. Your Wisdom Score increases by 1.

Shepherd. You have advantage on Animal Handling skill checks.

Forecast. You gain proficiency in the Survival skill. Once per long rest, you can predict the weather for the next 12 hours within a 5 miles radius with 90 percent accuracy. Magical alterations to the weather are not taken into consideration and are not predictable in this way.

Pliaran Orc

Pliaran Orcs embody the raw, untamed forces of nature, standing as the largest and most physically formidable of their kin. Reaching heights between seven and eight feet tall, these imposing beings make their homes within the deep caves and scattered camps across the sun-drenched, warmer regions of Pliara. Their towering frames, heavy builds, and prominent tusks give them an unmistakable presence that dominates any landscape they inhabit.

Unlike their nomadic or canopy-dwelling relatives, Pliaran Orcs are defined by a fierce, unrelenting lifestyle rooted in survival and physical power. They excel in tests of brute force, leaning into an aggressive, unpredictable nature that sets them apart from other Orcish societies. This relentless strength drives their culture, making them legendary figures whose sheer presence Commands respect and caution throughout the realm.

Tales of their brutality and power echo across every corner of Pliara, giving rise to countless stories and myths that shape how other races view them. Whether occupying rugged territories or defending their territory from outsiders, Pliaran Orcs remain a dominant and unyielding force, forever tied to the harsh, sun-baked environments they call home.

Ability Scores. Your Constitution Score increases by 1.

Aggression. As a bonus action, you can move up to your speed toward an enemy of your choice that you can see or hear. You must end this move closer to the enemy than you started.

Skills for the Clan. You gain proficiency with any one skill and any one tool of your choice.